

香港中學文憑考試

Hong Kong Diploma of Secondary Education Examination

Visual Arts

2025 Question Papers

(with marking schemes and comments on candidates' performance)

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香港考試及評核局
Hong Kong
Examinations and
Assessment Authority

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Introduction

This publication provides a comprehensive report on the Visual Arts examination in the 2025 Hong Kong Diploma of Secondary Education Examination. It covers various aspects of the examination, including the objectives, contents and format of the examination, the question papers, the marking schemes, and the chief examiners' comments on candidates' performance in the live examination. Some statistics are also included.

Through this publication, we hope to provide useful information and feedback to assist teachers in their teaching of the subject and students in their learning. Similar publications are also available for other subjects in the 2025 HKDSE. Besides, a series of publications and resource materials related to the HKDSE are also available for reference to schools, candidates and the public. These include information related to examination administration, assessment requirements, examination-related statistics and feedback provided to schools and other stakeholders. For details, please visit the Authority's website (http://www.hkeaa.edu.hk/en/HKDSE/info_corner/hkdse_publications_materials/).

We would like to take this opportunity to express our gratitude to all the examination personnel who were involved in the development of question papers and the assessment of candidates' performance. Without their contributions, it would not have been possible for us to conduct the examination smoothly.

The Examination

Objectives

The objectives of the public examination include the assessment of candidates' ability to:

- describe, analyse, interpret and evaluate artwork in writing;
- select and manipulate visual language, media, materials, tools and techniques appropriate for the creative expression and communication of a topic/theme or for solving a particular problem.

The objectives of SBA include the assessment of candidates' ability to:

- generate ideas through observation, experience, imagination, technology and other skills;
- develop themes of personal feelings or ideas, or social-related issues or ideas for problem solving through identifying, selecting and organizing primary and secondary resources;
- analyse, interpret and make critical judgment of artwork/art phenomena showing understanding of form, purpose, meaning and context in writing;
- transform and integrate experiences, knowledge and perspectives constructed from art appreciation and criticism, and other areas into art making practice;
- explore, select and manipulate appropriate visual language, media, materials, tools, skills, techniques and imagery for creative expression and communication of a theme or for the solving of a particular problem;
- continuously reflect on, respond to and evaluate their own and others' practice and work, and consequently modify their own work.

Synopsis of curriculum contents

For details, please refer to the Visual Arts Curriculum and Assessment Guide (Secondary 4 to 6) jointly prepared by the Curriculum Development Council and the Hong Kong Examinations and Assessment Authority.

PART ONE

Paper 1: Visual Presentation of a Theme

Part A: Art Appreciation and Criticism (45 minutes)
Write a critical appreciation of the reproductions of artwork provided.

Part B: Visual Arts Making (3 hours and 15 minutes)
Create a piece of artwork to present a theme. Candidates may submit a creative brief which may include notes, sketches or layouts produced during the examination to support their artwork, if necessary. The practical work and the creative brief will be assessed as a whole and no separate marks will be awarded to the creative brief.

Paper 2: Design

Part A: Design Appreciation and Criticism (45 minutes)
Write a critical appreciation of the reproductions of design provided.

Part B: Design (3 hours and 15 minutes)
Solve design problem(s) and present a design work. Candidates may submit a design brief which may include notes, sketches or layouts produced during the examination to support their design work, if necessary. The practical work and the design brief will be assessed as a whole and no separate marks will be awarded to the design brief.

PART TWO

SCHOOL-BASED ASSESSMENT (SBA)

Candidates are required to submit **ONE** portfolio which should consist of:

(a) **Research Workbook** (presentations on art appreciation and criticism in context in relation to art making/critical studies and research processes) showing:

- evidence (e.g. sketches, photographs, notes) of how ideas are generated and recorded through observation, experience, imagination, technology and other skills;
- exploration and development of a theme/topic for art appreciation and criticism, and art making;
- presentations on art appreciation and criticism in context in relation to art making/critical studies, with evidence of research into the socio-cultural and historical contexts of **more than one culture**; and criticism of artwork/art phenomena /visual cultures from different perspectives and with different aesthetic values to the candidates' own;
- how artists' work has influenced their own art making/critical studies;
- exploration of and experimentation with media, materials, skills and techniques for the presentation of the selected theme;
- reflection on, evaluation of and refining of their own work;

and

(b) **Artwork/Critical studies** (four pieces of work in the portfolio) for the presentation of the selected theme(s):

- All of the four pieces of work can be artwork, or one to three pieces of them can be critical studies;
- Any media, materials, skills and techniques can be used for the production of the artwork.

Mode of assessment

The public assessment will consist of a public examination component and a school-based assessment component as outlined in the following table:

Component		Weighting	Duration
Public Examination	Choose either Paper 1 or Paper 2: Paper 1- Visual presentation of a theme Paper 2- Design Each paper is divided into two parts: Part A 10% Part B 40%	50%	4 hours
School-based Assessment (SBA)	Submit ONE portfolio which should consist of: (a) Research workbook (20%) (b) Artwork/Critical studies (30%)	50%	

VISUAL ARTS PAPER 1

Visual Presentation of a Theme

8:30 am – 12:30 pm (4 hours)

Part A must be answered in English

INSTRUCTIONS

This paper consists of five questions. Attempt **ONE** question only. Complete both **Parts A and B** of the question. Candidates should first complete Part A.

Part A: Art Appreciation and Criticism (45 minutes)

Write a critical appreciation of the works of art provided. Write your answer in the answer book provided, which will be collected 45 minutes after the start of the examination. This section carries 20 marks.

Part B: Visual Arts Making (3 hours and 15 minutes)

On the white cartridge paper provided, create a piece of two-dimensional artwork using any medium, form, style and technique to present a theme. Creative briefs such as notes, sketches and layouts that you produce for the examination should be written or drawn on the white bond paper provided. The white bond paper may be submitted along with the finished work to explain your artwork. This section carries 80 marks.

Not to be taken away before the
end of the examination session

Attempt **ONE** of the following:

1. (A) Describe, analyse and compare the forms and expressions of Plate (1a) and Plate (1b); interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)



Plate (1a) Pieter Bruegel the Elder. *Children's Games*. 1560. Oil on Panel, 118 x 161 cm.



Plate (1b) Anonymous. *Engraved Moon and Unfolding Clouds* (鑲月開雲) (A leaf from *Spring Everlasting on the Abode of the Immortals* (蓬壺春永)) detail. The first year of Daoguang (道光元年) in Qing dynasty, ca. 1821 or later. Album leaf, ink and colours on paper, 61.5 x 77.5 cm.

- (B) Create a piece of two-dimensional work based on the theme 'Looking up at the Sky from a Brightly Lit City'. (80 marks)

2. (A) Describe, analyse and compare the forms and expressions of Plate (2a) and Plate (2b); interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)



Plate (2a) Inges Idee. *Anticipation*. 2018. Stainless steel circular bend pipes, wood, plastic composites, sandblast ground, LED light, 273 x 1148 x 850 cm.



Plate (2a.1) Side View



Plate (2a.2) Top View



Plate (2b) Bruno Catalano. *The Travellers J4*. 2022. Bronze, 310 x 120 x 110 cm.



Plate (2b.1) Side View



Plate (2b.2) Back View

(B) Create a piece of two-dimensional work based on the theme '*The Fantasy of Going Home*'. (80 marks)

3. (A) Describe, analyse and compare the forms and expressions of Plate (3a) and Plate (3b); interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)



Plate (3a) Mollie Bosworth. *Of Shadows and Light*. 2018. Cyanotype on 45 silk panels, 45 x 140 cm.



Plate (3a.1) Side View



Plate (3a.2) Detail 1



Plate (3a.2) Detail 2



Plate (3b) Philip Reinagle & Joseph Constantine Stadler. *Large Flowering Sensitive Plant*. 1799. Coloured aquatint on paper, 55.5 x 43.2 cm.

- (B) Create a piece of two-dimensional work based on the theme 'Midsummer Tree Shadow'.
(80 marks)

4. (A) Describe, analyse and compare the forms and expressions of Plate (4a) and Plate (4b); interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)



Plate (4a) John Woodrow Wilson. *Peasants*. 1952. Duco on masonite, 59.7 x 76.2 cm.
(Note: Duco is a brand name of a paint and masonite is a type of hardboard)



Plate (4b) David Hockney. *My Parents*. 1977. Oil on canvas, 183 x 183 cm.

- (B) Create a piece of two-dimensional work based on the theme '*Three People on the Early Morning Ferry*'. (80 marks)

5. (A) Describe, analyse and compare the forms and expressions of Plate (5a) and Plate (5b); interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)



Plate (5a) Joan Miró. *The Tilled Field*. 1923 - 1924. Oil on canvas, 66 x 92.7 cm.



Plate (5b) Dale Chihuly & Italo Scanga. *Rover's Garden Grows*. 1991. Mixed media, 174.6 x 169.2 x 55.2 cm.



Plate (5b.1) Detail 1



Plate (5b.2) Detail 2

- (B) Create a piece of two-dimensional work based on the theme '*An Animal Party in the Virtual World*'.
(80 marks)

END OF PAPER

Sources of materials used in this paper will be acknowledged in the *HKDSE Question Papers* booklet published by the Hong Kong Examinations and Assessment Authority at a later stage.

HONG KONG EXAMINATIONS AND ASSESSMENT AUTHORITY
HONG KONG DIPLOMA OF SECONDARY EDUCATION EXAMINATION 2025

VISUAL ARTS PAPER 2

Design

8:30 am – 12:30 pm (4 hours)

Part A must be answered in English

INSTRUCTIONS

This paper consists of five questions. Attempt **ONE** question only. Complete both **Parts A and B** of the question. Candidates should first complete Part A.

Part A: Design Appreciation and Criticism (45 minutes)

Write a critical appreciation of the works of design provided. Write your answer in the answer book provided, which will be collected 45 minutes after the start of the examination. This section carries 20 marks.

Part B: Design (3 hours and 15 minutes)

On the white cartridge paper provided, create a piece of design using any medium, form, style and technique to present a design. Design briefs such as notes, sketches and layouts that you produce for the examination should be written or drawn on the white bond paper provided. The white bond paper may be submitted along with the finished work to explain your design work. This section carries 80 marks.

Not to be taken away before the
end of the examination session

Attempt **ONE** of the following:

1. (A) Describe, analyse and compare Plate (1a) and Plate (1b) with respect to the design concepts, silhouettes, visual effects and communication effects of the two designs; interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)



Plate (1a) Noir Kei Ninomiya. Womenswear. Fall 2022.

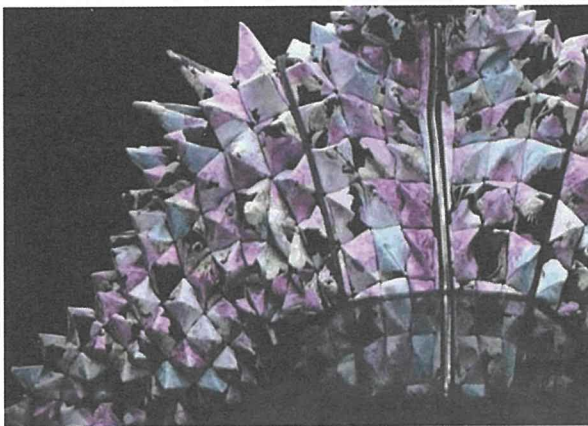


Plate (1a.1) Detail 1

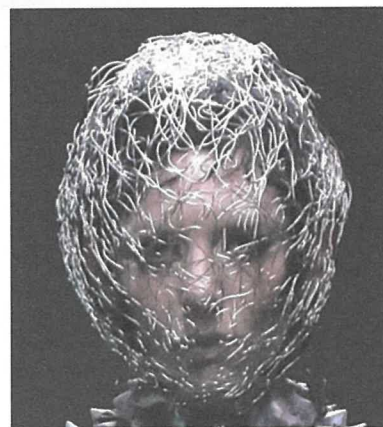


Plate (1a.2) Detail 2



Plate (1b) Loewe. Womenswear. Spring Summer 2023.



Plate (1b.1) Side view



Plate (1b.2) Detail 1



Plate (1b.3) Detail 2

(B) Based on the theme 'Early Spring', design **ONE** bridal gown and **ONE** bridesmaid dress.

Both designs should include:

- Headdress

EACH design item should have **TWO** 3-dimensional renderings with an indication of the measurements and materials used. (80 marks)

2. (A) Describe, analyse and compare Plate (2a) and Plate (2b) with respect to the design concepts, visual effects and communication effects of the two designs; interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)



Plate (2a) LAIMA Magazine. Advertisement. (Note: LAIMA is a Women's Fashion and Trend Magazine)

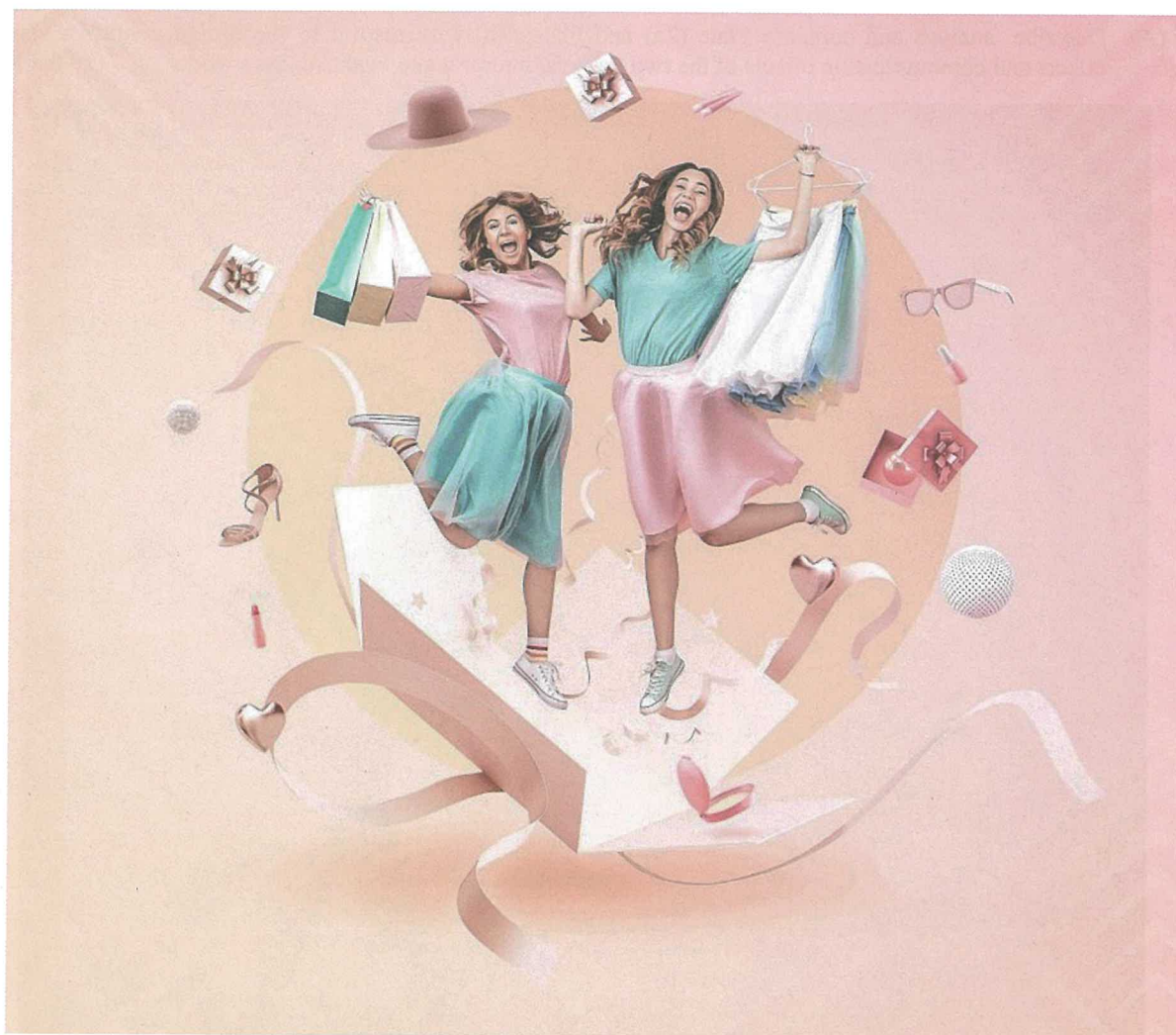


Plate (2b) Shopping Mall Advertisement.

- (B) Design a set of **TWO** promotional posters for an animation named 'Wonder Grandpa' (神奇祖父), to illustrate the characteristics of Wonder Grandpa which are 'tech elite' and 'sports elite' respectively.

The design of each poster should include:

- The name of the animation: Wonder Grandpa (神奇祖父) (in Chinese, English or both Chinese and English)

The measurements of **EACH** poster should be 35 cm x 20 cm (in vertical orientation).

(80 marks)

3. (A) Describe, analyse and compare Plate (3a) and Plate (3b) with respect to the design concepts, structures, visual effects and communication effects of the two designs; interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)



Plate (3a) HRUM&HRUM. Nuts Packaging. Paper and cloth.



Plate (3a.1) Back view



Plate (3a.2) Unfolded



Plate (3b) RICE MAN. Japanese White Rice Packaging. Cloth and straw.



Plate (3b.1) Detail 1



Plate (3b.2) Detail 2

- (B) Based on the theme 'Plants', design **TWO** yarns (Plate (3c) and Plate (3d)) packaging for a company named 'Furry' (毛毛). The textures of the two yarns are rough and soft respectively.

Each design item should:

- include the name of the company: 'Furry' (毛毛) (in Chinese, English or both Chinese and English)
- be able to contain **three pieces** of the same kind of yarn
- allow the product to be touched without opening the packaging

EACH design item should have **TWO** 3-dimensional renderings with an indication of the measurements and materials used. (80 marks)

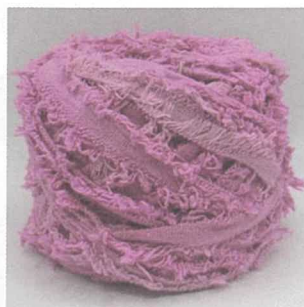


Plate (3c) Yarn 1
10 cm x 10 cm x 10 cm



Plate (3d) Yarn 2
10 cm x 10 cm x 10 cm

4. (A) Describe, analyse and compare Plate (4a) and Plate (4b) with respect to the design concepts, structures, visual effects and communication effects of the two designs; interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)



Plate (4a) *A Christmas Story*. Musical Stage Design.



Plate (4a.1) Scene 1

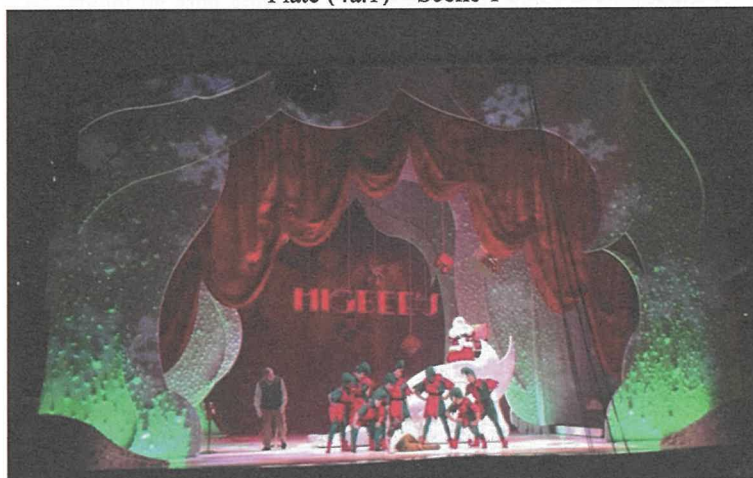


Plate (4a.2) Scene 2

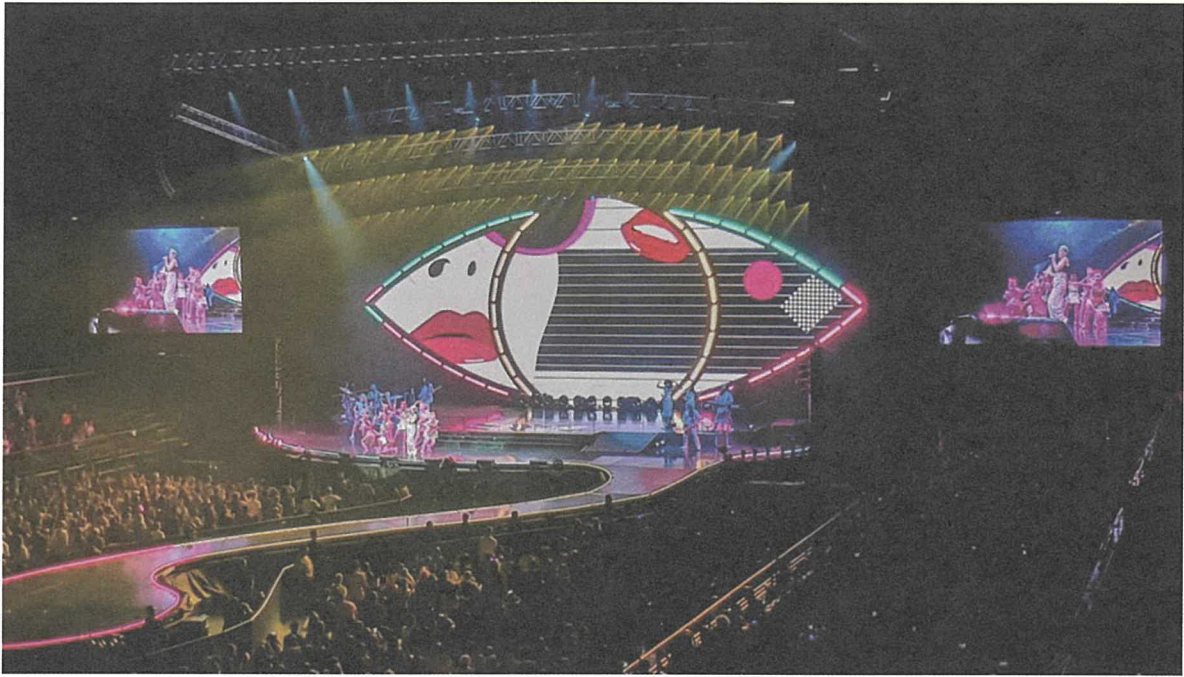


Plate (4b) *Witness: The Tour*. Concert Stage Design.

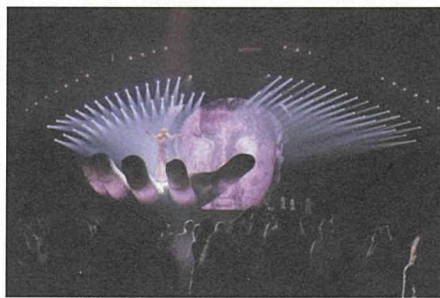


Plate (4b.1) Scene 1

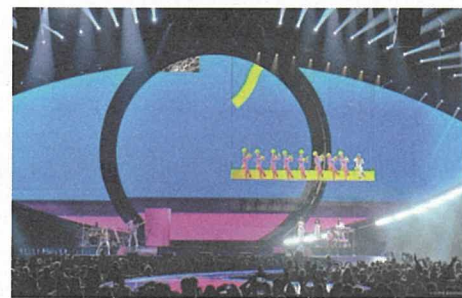


Plate (4b.2) Scene 2

- (B) For a children's drama named 'Adventure under the Sea', design **ONE** stage scene 'The Ancient City under the Sea'. The design should be applied in the performance venue as shown in Plate (4c).

The design should include:

- A submarine which carries an actor

The design should have **ONE** 3-dimensional rendering with an indication of the measurements and materials used. (80 marks)

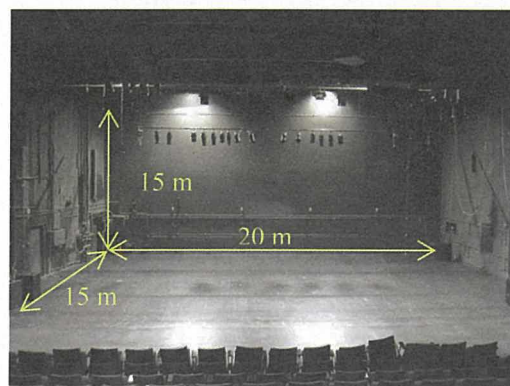


Plate (4c) The performance venue

5. (A) Describe, analyse and compare Plate (5a) and Plate (5b) with respect to the design concepts, visual effects and communication effects of the two designs; interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)



Plate (5a) FLOSLEK Sunscreen. Advertisement.



Plate (5b) Jeep Car. Advertisement.

- (B) Based on the theme 'Marathon 2026', design **THREE** consecutive pages of an online advertisement for social media on mobile devices to promote public participation.

The design of the first page should include:

- Marathon 2026 (馬拉松 2026) (in Chinese, English or both Chinese and English)

The design of the second page should include:

- 1-1-2026
- Central - Tsing Ma Bridge (中環—青馬大橋)(in Chinese, English or both Chinese and English)

The design of the third page should include:

- Sign up now (立即報名) (in Chinese, English or both Chinese and English)

The measurements of **EACH** page should be 15 cm x 15 cm.

(80 marks)

END OF PAPER

Sources of materials used in this paper will be acknowledged in the *HKDSE Question Papers* booklet published by the Hong Kong Examinations and Assessment Authority at a later stage.

Marking Guidelines

This document was prepared for markers' reference. It should not be regarded as a set of model answers. Candidates and teachers who were not involved in the marking process are advised to interpret its content with care.

PAPER 1 Visual Presentation of a Theme

Part A (20 marks)

With regard to the artwork provided, candidates are assessed on whether they can provide:

1. Precise detail in description
2. A reasonable depth of analysis
3. An in-depth interpretation and evaluation from varied perspectives

The mark allocation is listed as below:

Marks/ Rubrics Marking Criteria	High	Middle				Low	Not Shown
	5	4	3	2	1	0	
Literal Description	Able to link different relevant foci, discover hidden details, and comprehend with innovative ideas	Able to link different relevant foci, and identify their relationships	Able to seek out many relevant, but not interrelated foci	Able to provide a single or barely relevant foci	Only provide plain description, vague and irrelevant foci		
Formal Analysis	Able to connect with many relevant experiences and analyse effectively key message of artwork through integrative understanding of art forms	Able to connect art form in many related experiences and feelings, knowing the relationships among forms, and attempting to analyse key message of artwork	Able to connect different experiences and feelings with the visual form, without knowing the relationship among forms	Able to develop only single, linear and isolated recognition of visual form, without connecting to any experiences or feelings	Unable to develop basic understanding of visual forms		
Interpretation of Meaning	Able to present innovative interpretation through comprehending of multiple layers of meaning toward forms of presentation	Able to compare or contrast many interpretations of meaning toward forms of presentation	Able to provide multiple interpretations of meaning toward forms of presentation	Able to provide certain interpretations of meaning toward forms of presentation	Unable to provide any interpretations toward forms of presentation		
Value Judgment	Able to integrate multiple criteria, and judge on the appropriateness ¹ and effectiveness ² in delivering the key message of presentation in different contexts	Able to quote multiple criteria to judge on the appropriateness and effectiveness in delivering the key message of presentation	Able to propose multiple criteria, yet unable to judge on the appropriateness in delivering the key message of presentation	Able to propose one or two criteria, yet without judging on the appropriateness of presentation	Unable to make any judgment on designated artwork		

¹ 'Appropriateness' is the capability of selecting suitable forms or images for desired, intended or expected outcome.

² 'Effectiveness' is the capability of producing a desired, intended or expected outcome.

Part B (80 marks)

Candidates are assessed on their ability to select and manipulate visual language, media, materials, tools and techniques appropriate for the creative expression, communication of a theme or solving a particular problem.

On the white cartridge paper provided, create a piece of two-dimensional artwork using any medium, form, style and technique to present a theme. This section carries 80 marks.

General Marking Criteria

With reference to the application of the visual element, the articulation of art media, the technique, the visual effect and visual communication; evaluate the candidates' ability to:

1. present the theme in a personal and creative way
2. select means of visual self-expression and determine the most appropriate method of communicating an idea, a thought, a feeling, a sentiment, etc.
3. demonstrate competence in dealing with visual elements
4. select and apply appropriate medium, techniques and processes in the execution and production of a painting

The mark allocation is listed as below:

Marks/ Rubrics	High	Middle			Low	Not Shown
Marking Criteria	17-20	13-16	9-12	5-8	1-4	0
Selection and Use of Materials & Techniques	Able to select and master the materials and the skills accurately and effectively in implementing the key message of the theme	Able to master the materials and the skills appropriately and effectively in outstanding the key message of the theme	Able to master the materials and the skills appropriately in delivering the key message of the theme	Able to use the materials and the skills relevant to the theme	Unable to use the materials and the skills to cope with the theme	
Selection and Use of Visual Elements and Principles of Design	Able to select and master multiple visual elements and principles of design, accurately and effectively in implementing the key message of the theme	Able to master multiple visual elements and principles of design appropriately and effectively in outstanding the key message of the theme	Able to master the visual elements and principles of design appropriately in delivering the key message of the theme	Able to use the visual elements and principles of design relevant to the theme	Unable to use the visual elements and principles of design to cope with the theme	
Creativity & Imagination	Able to demonstrate personality characteristics through originality and unique imagination	Able to demonstrate personality characteristics through originality and rich imagination	Able to demonstrate personality characteristics through originality and by means of transference or association	Able to demonstrate personality characteristics or originality	Unable to show personality characteristics or originality	
Communication of the Theme	Able to integrate relevant forms of artistic creation in different emotions or idea	Able to use multiple, relevant and coordinate forms of artistic creation in different emotions or idea	Able to use relevant and coordinate forms of artistic creation in different emotions or idea	Only use irrelevant forms of artistic creation in different emotions or idea	Unable to use any relevant forms of artistic creation in different emotions or idea	

Specific Marking Criteria for Each Question:

1. (A) Describe, analyse and compare the forms and expressions of Plate (1a) and Plate (1b); interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)

There are no model answers for questions requiring comparison and contrast, analysis, and interpretation. Responses must be judged on the basis of viewpoints provided and communication of:

1. Literal Description
Precise detail in description

Comparison	Pieter Bruegel the Elder's <i>Children's Games</i>	Anonymous <i>Engraved Moon and Unfolding Clouds</i>
Commonalities	▪ realistic approach ▪ meticulous brushstroke ▪ foreground, middle ground and background ▪ aerial view presenting an expansive space	
Differences	▪ genre painting ▪ oil on panel ▪ one-point perspective ▪ children's games as subject matter ▪ a square, a street and a river are in the foreground, middle ground and the background. Hundreds of children are joyfully playing ▪ earth tone ▪ brown, green, yellow, orange, red, blue and black	▪ Chinese court painting ▪ ink and colours on paper ▪ multiple perspectives ▪ palace halls and garden scenery as subject matter ▪ the foreground is a small, hilly wood with a palace built on a stone foundation. The palace, with colourful glazed tile roof, richly decorated columns, beams, eaves, doors and windows, is surrounded by faux rocks, lush and elegant flowers and trees. The middle ground is several palaces with more subtle decorations, a pavilion and a colonnade/corridor. The background is rolling mountains, some of which are covered with trees. ▪ unstated, elegant tone ▪ brown, green, pink, red, purple, blue and white

2. Formal Analysis
A reasonable depth of analysis
 - the idea and the theme
 - the characteristics of the media
 - the approaches of art making
3. Interpretation of Meaning
An in-depth interpretation from varied perspectives
4. Value Judgment
An in-depth evaluation from varied perspectives

- (B) Create a piece of two-dimensional work based on the theme 'Looking up at the Sky from a Brightly Lit City'. (80 marks)

1. Selection and Use of Materials & Techniques
2. Selection and Use of Visual Elements and Principles of Design
3. Creativity & Imagination
4. Communication of the Theme

Focus:

- to depict the scene of the sky from a brightly lit city
- the application of the visual elements, articulation of art media, techniques, and visual effects

2. (A) Describe, analyse and compare the forms and expressions of Plate (2a) and Plate (2b); interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)

There are no model answers for questions requiring comparison and contrast, analysis, and interpretation. Responses must be judged on the basis of viewpoints provided and communication of:

1. Literal Description
Precise detail in description

Comparison	Inges Idee's <i>Anticipation</i>	Bruno Catalano's <i>The Travelers J4</i>
Commonalities	▪ travel as subject matter ▪ sculpture ▪ public art	
Differences	▪ mixed media ▪ a child is carrying luggage and pulling a toy train, standing next to a train station, ready to travel ▪ overlays of different-coloured circular stainless steels tubes form the child, luggage and toy train, with LED lights installed on the ground ▪ high saturation. grey, green, yellow, orange, red, blue, purple, white and black	▪ bronze ▪ a man dressed in a sweater, long pants, and leather shoes, with a suitcase in his left hand, is striding forward ▪ the head, shoulders, hands, and legs of the sculpture standing on a pedestal are partly hollowed out revealing the empty interior/cavities ▪ yellow, blue, brown, green, red and black

2. Formal Analysis
A reasonable depth of analysis
 - the idea and the theme
 - the characteristics of the media
 - the approaches of art making
3. Interpretation of Meaning
An in-depth interpretation from varied perspectives
4. Value Judgment
An in-depth evaluation from varied perspectives

- (B) Create a piece of two-dimensional work based on the theme '*The Fantasy of Going Home*'. (80 marks)

1. Selection and Use of Materials & Techniques
2. Selection and Use of Visual Elements and Principles of Design
3. Creativity & Imagination
4. Communication of the Theme

Focus:

- to illustrate the scene of the fantasy of going home
- the application of the visual elements, articulation of art media, techniques, and visual effects

3. (A) Describe, analyse and compare the forms and expressions of Plate (3a) and Plate (3b); interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)

There are no model answers for questions requiring comparison and contrast, analysis, and interpretation. Responses must be judged on the basis of viewpoints provided and communication of:

1. Literal Description
Precise detail in description

Comparison	Mollie Bosworth's <i>Of Shadows and Light</i>	Philip Reinagle & Joseph Constantine Stadler's <i>Large Flowering Sensitive Plant</i>
Commonalities	▪ plant as subject matter	
Differences	▪ cyanotype on silk ▪ a steel frame hangs 45 cyanotypes on silk, each of which presents the image of plants/flowers with a strong contrast of light and shadow ▪ positive and negative silhouette ▪ use overlapping images to create a sense of layering tones of blue ▪ blue, white and grey	▪ aquatint print ▪ the foreground is a large flowering sensitive plant, partly in buds and partly in blossom with trailing fringes, as well as two birds. The middle ground is a male native inhabitant. The background is rolling mountains and blue sky ▪ lines are finely drawn ▪ the plant is in the middle to create a balanced composition ▪ green, brown, black, purple red, yellow, orange, blue, white and grey

2. Formal Analysis
A reasonable depth of analysis
 - the idea and the theme
 - the characteristics of the media
 - the approaches of art making
3. Interpretation of Meaning
An in-depth interpretation from varied perspectives
4. Value Judgment
An in-depth evaluation from varied perspectives

- (B) Create a piece of two-dimensional work based on the theme 'Midsummer Tree Shadow'. (80 marks)

1. Selection and Use of Materials & Techniques
2. Selection and Use of Visual Elements and Principles of Design
3. Creativity & Imagination
4. Communication of the Theme

Focus:

- to depict the scene of tree shadow in the midsummer
- the application of the visual elements, articulation of art media, techniques, and visual effects

4. (A) Describe, analyse and compare the forms and expressions of Plate (4a) and Plate (4b); interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)

There are no model answers for questions requiring comparison and contrast, analysis, and interpretation. Responses must be judged on the basis of viewpoints provided and communication of:

1. Literal Description
Precise detail in description

Comparison	John Woodrow Wilson's <i>Peasants</i>	David Hockney's <i>My Parents</i>
Commonalities	▪ family as subject matter ▪ realistic approach ▪ eye-level	
Differences	▪ Duco on Masonite ▪ a young couple and a child sitting on a bus ▪ they are in modest wear. The man is holding a hat, and the woman is wearing a scarf. They lower their heads, without facial expressions. The child sits between the couple and is held tightly by the woman, with his hands on his forehead. The couple's hands are large and disproportionate ▪ the car compartment is simple, with buildings outside ▪ bust portrait painting ▪ earth tone ▪ brown, white, blue and black ▪ highlights on their faces and hands	▪ oil on canvas ▪ an elderly couple sitting in a room ▪ the white-haired woman, dressed in a blue dress and brown shoes, sits upright on a chair, facing forward. The man is wearing a suit with black shoes, facing his wife, and lowering his head to read ▪ simple interior furnishings. The background is a pale green wall. Between them is a green, wheeled cabinet and a purple carpet on the ground. A vase with red and orange flowers on the cabinet; a mirror reflecting the décor in the room; a few books on the lower level of the cabinet ▪ full body portrait painting ▪ high saturation ▪ green, blue, orange, red, purple, brown, white, black ▪ light source from the left

2. Formal Analysis
A reasonable depth of analysis
 - the idea and the theme
 - the characteristics of the media
 - the approaches of art making
3. Interpretation of Meaning
An in-depth interpretation from varied perspectives
4. Value Judgment
An in-depth evaluation from varied perspectives

- (B) Create a piece of two-dimensional work based on the theme 'Three People on the Early Morning Ferry'. (80 marks)

1. Selection and Use of Materials & Techniques
2. Selection and Use of Visual Elements and Principles of Design
3. Creativity & Imagination
4. Communication of the Theme

Focus:

- to depict the different scenes and activity of three people on the early morning ferry
- the application of the visual elements, articulation of art media, techniques, and visual effects

5. (A) Describe, analyse and compare the forms and expressions of Plate (5a) and Plate (5b); interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)

There are no model answers for questions requiring comparison and contrast, analysis, and interpretation. Responses must be judged on the basis of viewpoints provided and communication of:

1. Literal Description
Precise detail in description

Comparison	Joan Miró's <i>The Tilled Field</i>	Dale Chihuly & Italo Scanga's <i>Rover's Garden Grows</i>
Commonalities	▪ plants and animals as subject matter ▪ surrealistic approach ▪ use organic and geometric shapes	
Differences	▪ oil on canvas ▪ a village scene ▪ at the centre is a house; on the left is a tree-like object with several flags hanging; the forms of plants and animals are distorted. A huge eye and a big ear are attached to the tree trunk. A piece of folded paper with a word is under a tree ▪ the painting is divided into three areas by two horizontal lines. A diagonal line divides the painting into day and night ▪ yellow, brown, black, blue, red and grey	▪ 3-dimensional work, mixed media ▪ a garden scene ▪ there is a table-like stand made of metal. A few vases are placed horizontally on the tabletop. Two flowers grow upward, and the others are placed randomly. A seated dog is upside down under the tabletop ▪ the objects on the tabletop made of glass in brilliant colours are in greatly contrast with the metal stand in metallic colour ▪ green, yellow, orange, pink and metallic colour

2. Formal Analysis
A reasonable depth of analysis
 - the idea and the theme
 - the characteristics of the media
 - the approaches of art making
3. Interpretation of Meaning
An in-depth interpretation from varied perspectives
4. Value Judgment
An in-depth evaluation from varied perspectives

- (B) Create a piece of two-dimensional artwork based on the theme 'An Animal Party in the Virtual World'. (80 marks)

1. Selection and Use of Materials & Techniques
2. Selection and Use of Visual Elements and Principles of Design
3. Creativity & Imagination
4. Communication of the Theme

Focus:

- to illustrate the scene and emotion of an animal party in the virtual world
- the application of the visual elements, articulation of art media, techniques, and visual effects

PAPER 2 Design

Part A (20 marks)

With regard to the design work provided, candidates are assessed on whether they can provide:

1. Precise detail in description
2. A reasonable depth of analysis
3. An in-depth interpretation and evaluation from varied perspectives

The mark allocation is listed as below:

Marks/ Rubrics Marking Criteria	High	Middle			Low	Not Shown
	5	4	3	2	1	0
Literal Description	Able to link different relevant foci, discover hidden details, and comprehend with innovative ideas	Able to link different relevant foci, and identify their relationships	Able to seek out many relevant, but not interrelated foci	Able to provide a single or barely relevant foci	Only provide plain description, vague and irrelevant foci	
Formal Analysis	Able to connect with many relevant experiences and analyse effectively key message of artwork through integrative understanding of art forms	Able to connect art form in many related experiences and feelings, knowing the relationships among forms, and attempting to analyse key message of artwork	Able to connect different experiences and feelings with the visual form, without knowing the relationship among forms	Able to develop only single, linear and isolated recognition of visual form, without connecting to any experiences or feelings	Unable to develop basic understanding of visual forms	
Interpretation of Meaning	Able to present innovative interpretation through comprehending of multiple layers of meaning toward forms of presentation	Able to compare or contrast many interpretations of meaning toward forms of presentation	Able to provide multiple interpretations of meaning toward forms of presentation	Able to provide certain interpretations of meaning toward forms of presentation	Unable to provide any interpretations toward forms of presentation	
Value Judgment	Able to integrate multiple criteria, and judge on the appropriateness ¹ and effectiveness ² in delivering the key message of presentation in different contexts	Able to quote multiple criteria to judge on the appropriateness and effectiveness in delivering the key message of presentation	Able to propose multiple criteria, yet unable to judge on the appropriateness in delivering the key message of presentation	Able to propose one or two criteria, yet without judging on the appropriateness of presentation	Unable to make any judgment on designated artwork	

¹ 'Appropriateness' is the capability of selecting suitable forms or images for desired, intended or expected outcome.

² Effectiveness is the capability of producing a desired, intended or expected outcome.

Part B (80 marks)

Candidates are assessed on their ability to select and manipulate visual language, media, materials, tools and techniques appropriate for the creative expression, communication of a theme or solving a particular problem.

On the white cartridge paper provided, create a piece of two-dimensional design work using any medium, form, style and technique to present a theme. This section carries 80 marks.

General marking guidelines:

With reference to the application of the visual element, the articulation of art media, technique, visual effect, idea development and design principles, evaluate the candidates' ability in the following areas:

1. Solving design problems

The extent to which the candidate is successfully proposes feasible solutions for a given problem, and is able to develop design concepts which convey the ideas of a theme.

2. Presenting ideas by using media, material and technique

The extent to which the candidate is able successfully to apply the appropriate media, technique, and visual style to present the solution proposed.

3. Understanding and organization

The extent to which the candidate is able successfully to apply appropriate visual elements such as colour, pattern, texture, shape, form; and design principles such as contrast, rhythm, balance and emphasis.

4. Communication

The extent to which the candidate is able convincingly to convey a theme.

5. Meeting design requirements

The extent to which the candidate is able successfully to create a design that meets specific size, measurement and other requirements of the question.

6. Demonstrating originality

The extent to which the candidate is able to successfully convey design ideas which are original and creative.

The mark allocation is listed as below:

Marks/ Rubrics Marking Criteria	High	Middle			Low	Not Shown
	17-20	13-16	9-12	5-8	1-4	0
Selection and Use of Materials & Techniques	Able to select and master the materials and the skills accurately and effectively in implementing the key message of the theme	Able to master the materials and the skills appropriately and effectively in outstanding the key message of the theme	Able to master the materials and the skills appropriately in delivering the key message of the theme	Able to use the materials and the skills relevant to the theme	Unable to use the materials and the skills to cope with the theme	
Selection and Use of Visual Elements and Principles of Design	Able to select and master multiple visual elements and principles of design, accurately and effectively in implementing the key message of the theme	Able to master multiple visual elements and principles of design appropriately and effectively in outstanding the key message of the theme	Able to master the visual elements and principles of design appropriately in delivering the key message of the theme	Able to use the visual elements and principles of design relevant to the theme	Unable to use the visual elements and principles of design to cope with the theme	
Creativity & Imagination	Able to demonstrate personality characteristics through originality and unique imagination	Able to demonstrate personality characteristics through originality and rich imagination	Able to demonstrate personality characteristics through originality and by means of transference or association	Able to demonstrate personality characteristics or originality	Unable to show personality characteristics or originality	
Communication of the Theme	Able to integrate relevant forms of artistic creation in different emotions or idea	Able to use multiple, relevant and coordinate forms of artistic creation in different emotions or idea	Able to use relevant and coordinate forms of artistic creation in different emotions or idea	Only use irrelevant forms of artistic creation in different emotions or idea	Unable to use any relevant forms of artistic creation in different emotions or idea	

Specific marking criteria:

1. (A) Describe, analyse and compare Plate (1a) and Plate (1b) with respect to the design concepts, silhouettes, visual effects and communication effects of the two designs; interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)

With regards to the designs, candidates are assessed on whether they can give:

1. Literal Description
Precise detail in description

Comparison	Noir Kei Ninimiya's Womenswear	Loewe's Womenswear
Commonalities	▪ women's clothing ▪ western-style skirt	
Differences	Outfit: a lady is wearing a wire-made headdress that cover the entire head, a zip up coat quilted with square cones of different sizes, and a knee-length layered tulle gored skirt. Paired with a pair of socks and Oxford shoes of the same color Colour: black, purple, blue and white Concept: defense	Outfit: a lady with short hair is wearing a striped short shirtdress, fitted top with polo collar, buttoned placket and cap sleeves. An ultra-short gathered skirt with vertical strips extends from the tight top to the skirt. Paired with a pair of high heels covered with uninflated balloons Colour: light blue, white and red Concept: adorable and playful

2. Formal Analysis
A reasonable depth of analysis
 - The inter-relationships among the various visual characteristics
 - Differences in function
 - The relation between materials and structure selection and product's nature
 - Relation between the product and user
3. Interpretation of Meaning
An in-depth interpretation from varied perspectives
4. Value Judgment
An in-depth evaluation from varied perspectives

- (B) Based on the theme 'Early Spring', design **ONE** bridal gown and **ONE** bridesmaid dress.

Both designs should include:

- Headdress

EACH design item should have **TWO** 3-dimensional renderings with an indication of the measurements and materials used. (80 marks)

With regards to the design, candidates are assessed on whether they can demonstrate:

1. Selection and Use of Materials & Techniques
2. Selection and Use of Visual Elements and Principles of Design
3. Creativity & Imagination
4. Skills of Communication of the Theme

Focus:

- The design corresponds with the theme: Early Spring
- The characteristics of the image styling for bridal gown and bridesmaid dress are coordinated with design
- The use of the materials is suitable for the design

2. (A) Describe, analyse and compare Plate (2a) and Plate (2b) with respect to the design concepts, visual effects and communication effects of the two designs; interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)

With regards to the designs, candidates are assessed on whether they can give:

1. Literal Description
Precise detail in description

Comparison	LAIMA Magazine Advertisement	Shopping Mall Advertisement
Commonalities	▪ advertising ▪ feminine theme ▪ digital composite images ▪ gradient color as the background	
Differences	Image: a woman wearing a dark brown jacket, tight pants, high heels, and long hair walking out from an iron cage sculpted in the form of floor sweeping woman from the dark left to the bright right. There is a women's magazine and a slogan in the lower right corner Colour: brown and red, warm gray tones Typeface: Sans serif handwriting Concept: escape	Image: in the center, a circle framed an opened box at the bottom with its sides and ribbons popping outward. Two long-haired ladies wearing T-shirts, short skirts, socks, and sneakers in matching styles but different colors leaped from the box. They were smiling and holding up clothes hangers with dresses and shopping bags. Surrounding the circle are a high-heeled shoe, a compact, lipstick, glasses, a wide-brimmed hat, gift boxes, heart-shaped metals, and disco balls Colour: different tones of pink, turquoise and white Typeface: nil Concept: joy and excitement

2. Formal Analysis
A reasonable depth of analysis
 - The usage of colour, shape, symbols and type, and composition of the designs
 - The relation between graphics, colour selection and designs
3. Interpretation of Meaning
An in-depth interpretation from varied perspectives
4. Value Judgment
An in-depth evaluation from varied perspectives

- (B) Design a set of **TWO** promotional posters for an animation named 'Wonder Grandpa' (神奇祖父), to illustrate the characteristics of Wonder Grandpa which are 'tech elite' and 'sports elite'.

The design of each poster should include:

- The name of the animation: Wonder Grandpa (神奇祖父) (in Chinese, English or both Chinese and English)

The measurements of **EACH** poster should be 35 cm x 20 cm (in vertical orientation).

(80 marks)

With regards to the design, candidates are assessed on whether they can demonstrate:

1. Selection and Use of Materials & Techniques
2. Selection and Use of Visual Elements and Principles of Design
3. Creativity & Imagination
4. Skills of Communication of the Theme

Focus:

- The design corresponds with the theme: Wonder Grandpa, animation
- The design corresponds with the characteristics of wonder grandpa: tech elite and sports elite
- Text, visuals and messages (wonder grandpa, tech elite and sports elite) are incorporated effectively in the design
- Readability and legibility should be well considered in the design

3. (A) Describe, analyse and compare Plate (3a) and Plate (3b) with respect to the design concepts, structures, visual effects and communication effects of the two designs; interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)

With regards to the designs, candidates are assessed on whether they can give:

1. Literal Description
Precise detail in description

Comparison	HRUM&HRUM's Nuts Packaging	RICEMAN's Japanese White Rice Packaging
Commonalities	▪ food packaging ▪ use cloth bags to carry products ▪ head images as the theme	
Differences	Structure: a bag full of nuts is wrapped in the middle with a piece of die-cut cardboard with an image of a squirrel's head, forming a squirrel with stuffed cheeks. The top center of the cardboard has a handle with the trademark and a product nameplate. The back of the cardboard displayed a product nutrition label reference and a barcode Colour: brown, red, black and white Typeface: Sans serif Materials: cloth and paper Concept: premium	Structure: three cloth bags of different sizes filled with rice, with a mustachioed man's face painted on the front, and a weight seal and a trademark on the side. The mouth of the bag is tied with a straw like a human head with tied hair. A straw hat painted with scales on the inside, sits atop the head Colour: light brown and black Typeface: script fonts Materials: cloth and straw Concept: authentic

2. Formal Analysis
A reasonable depth of analysis
 - The inter-relationships among the various visual characteristics
 - Differences in function
 - The relation between materials and structure selection and product's nature
 - Relation between the product and user
3. Interpretation of Meaning
An in-depth interpretation from varied perspectives
4. Value Judgment
An in-depth evaluation from varied perspectives

- (B) Based on the theme 'Plants', design **TWO** yarns (Plate (3c) and Plate (3d)) packaging for a company named 'Furry' (毛毛). The textures of the two yarns are rough and soft respectively.

Each design item should:

- include the name of the company: 'Furry' (毛毛) (in Chinese, English or both Chinese and English)
- be able to contain **three pieces** of the same kind of yarn
- allow the product to be touched without opening the packaging

EACH design item should have **TWO** 3-dimensional renderings with an indication of the measurements and materials used. (80 marks)

With regards to the design, candidates are assessed on whether they can demonstrate:

1. Selection and Use of Materials & Techniques
2. Selection and Use of Visual Elements and Principles of Design
3. Creativity & Imagination
4. Communication of the Theme

Focus:

- The design corresponds with the theme: plants
- The coherence of the visual effect (textures of the two yarns: rough and soft) is considered in the design
- Text, visuals and messages are incorporated effectively in the design

4. (A) Describe, analyse and compare Plate (4a) and Plate (4b) with respect to the design concepts, structures, visual effects and communication effects of the two designs; interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)

With regards to the designs, candidates are assessed on whether they can give:

1. Literal Description
Precise detail in description

Comparison	<i>A Christmas Story</i> Musical Stage Design	<i>Witness: The Tour</i> Concert Stage Design
Commonalities	▪ stage design ▪ indoor venues ▪ multiple scenes created by lights and scenery	
Differences	Structure: Proscenium-arch stage with multi-layered streamlined side curtains imitating the cold winter. A rotating centre stage displays multiple indoor and outdoor scenes. Different props and devices are added to match different scenes Lighting: the light source is concentrated in the center of the stage, with background light on both sides to create indoor and outdoor atmospheres with different storylines Materials: metal, wood and cloth Concept: reappearing the cold winter in the West	Structure: thrust stage with a simple geometric shape of a big eye frame as the main stage background, with a tear-shaped extension from the stage to the auditorium. Multiple components on the main stage can be raised and lowered, such as palms, heads, and hanging platform to enhance the visual effects of the singer's performance. Large electronic screens hang on both sides of the stage Lighting: the light source is concentrated on the singers and dancers with obvious changes in light and shade Materials: metal, wood and electronic screens Concept: experience

2. Formal Analysis
A reasonable depth of analysis
 - The inter-relationships among the various visual characteristics
 - Differences in function
 - The relation between materials and structure selection and design's nature
 - Relation between the design and user
3. Interpretation of Meaning
An in-depth interpretation from varied perspectives
4. Value Judgment
An in-depth evaluation from varied perspectives

- (B) For a children's drama named 'Adventure under the Sea', design **ONE** stage scene 'The Ancient City under the Sea'. The design should be applied in the performance venue as shown in Plate (4c).

The design should include:

- A submarine which carries an actor

The design should have **ONE** 3-dimensional renderings with an indication of the measurements and materials used. (80 marks)

With regards to the design, candidates are assessed on whether they can demonstrate:

1. Selection and Use of Materials & Techniques
2. Selection and Use of Visual Elements and Principles of Design
3. Creativity & Imagination
4. Communication of the Theme

Focus:

- The design corresponds with the theme: adventure under the sea and the ancient city under the sea
- The design corresponds with the characteristics of the place where it is placed: the indoor performance venue
- Ergonomics and safety (for the actors and the participants) are taken into consideration in the design
- The suitability of materials is well considered in the design

5. (A) Describe, analyse and compare Plate (5a) and Plate (5b) with respect to the design concepts, visual effects and communication effects of the two designs; interpret and evaluate these works. (20 marks)

With regards to the designs, candidates are assessed on whether they can give:

1. Literal Description
Precise detail in description

Comparison	FLOSLEK Sunscreen Advertisement.	Jeep Car Advertisement
Commonalities	▪ printed advertising ▪ surreal approach ▪ digital composite images ▪ Sans-serifs ▪ overlooking angle ▪ product name is on the right side of the advertisement ▪ diagonal composition	
Differences	Image: the upper left is a forest, and the lower right is a blue sea with several people swimming. In the center is a beach with a huge sunscreen skin cream lying across, and casting a huge shadow under the sunlight. People gather under the shadow and engage in different activities. Two birds are flying in the sky. The product and product name are placed in the lower right corner Colour: orange, brown, blue, green, white and black Concept: protection	Image: a car is driving from the lower left to the upper right on the map. The car stretches out the passing contour lines and distorts some of the text Colour: green, red, yellow, white and black Concept: no obstruction

2. Formal Analysis
A reasonable depth of analysis
 - The usage of colour, shape, symbols and type, and composition of the designs
 - The relation between graphics, colour selection and designs
3. Interpretation of Meaning
An in-depth interpretation from varied perspectives
4. Value Judgment
An in-depth evaluation from varied perspectives

- (B) Based on the theme 'Marathon 2026', design **THREE** consecutive pages of an online advertisement for social media on mobile devices to promote public participation.

The first page should include:

- Marathon 2026 (馬拉松 2026) (in Chinese, English or both Chinese and English)

The second page should include:

- 1-1-2026
- Central -Tsing Ma Bridge (中環—青馬大橋)(in Chinese, English or both Chinese and English)

The third page should include:

- Sign up now (立即報名) (in Chinese, English or both Chinese and English)

The measurements of **EACH** page should be 15 cm x 15 cm.

(80 marks)

With regards to the design, candidates are assessed on whether they can demonstrate:

1. Selection and Use of Materials & Techniques
2. Selection and Use of Visual Elements and Principles of Design
3. Creativity & Imagination
4. Communication of the Theme

Focus:

- The design corresponds with the text messages, visuals and theme: Marathon 2026
- The design corresponds with the characteristics of the place where it is placed: mobile devices
- Text, visuals and messages (1-1-2026, Central -Tsing Ma Bridge and sign up now) are incorporated effectively in the design
- Readability and legibility are considered in the design

Candidates' Performance

This year, 3855 candidates sat the examination, with 2592 candidates taking Paper 1 and 1263 taking Paper 2.

Public Examination

Paper 1 Visual Presentation of a Theme

In general, most candidates in Part A were able to seek out a variety of relevant foci in literal descriptions. Some candidates were able to connect different experiences and feelings with the visual forms, providing multiple interpretations of meaning towards the form of presentation. Some responded to one or two criteria related to the value judgment of the designated artwork to judge the appropriateness of the presentation.

For Part B, most candidates demonstrated a mastery of the materials and skills appropriate to delivering the key messages of the theme. They were able to express the key messages of the artwork using visual language. Most candidates demonstrated personality traits and originality by means of transference or association. Some good artworks displayed the hidden meaning of the given theme and reflected the understanding of the theme. However, some candidates answered the questions without fully understanding the requirements and produced superficial work. Candidates are reminded to read the questions carefully.

Question No.	Popularity (%)	Performance in General
1	22	Satisfactory. Most candidates used neon lights to convey the atmosphere of a brightly lit city. Some candidates provided an imaginative scene with elaborate and appealing content. The best scripts conveyed a viewpoint of 'looking up' and showed good illustration skills. However, some works showed a lack of composition skills, with a messy arrangement of images.
2	35	Good. Most candidates used dreams to create fantasies about going home. Most candidates used a surrealistic style to present their response to the theme. Some candidates provided a scene depicting 'war' and 'peace' in order to deliver abundant content with great significance. Some candidates left out the element of 'fantasy' and simply painted a scene without contextualisation. The interpretation of the theme in such cases was flat and tedious.
3	12	Satisfactory. Most of the candidates used a realistic style to express their response to the theme. Some candidates used the scene of enjoying the coolness under a tree to express the feeling of 'midsummer' directly. Some candidates creatively constructed the sense of 'midsummer' and 'tree shadow' and expressed the theme lively and effectively. Some candidates only attended to the superficial meaning of 'tree shadow' without subtlety or imagination.
4	16	Good. Most candidates used a realistic style to present the theme. They demonstrated varied expression of colour, line, composition and perspective. Some candidates used an unexpected incident to describe the situation of three people on the ferry and provided the work with good and funny details. However, some candidates misunderstood the scene of a 'ferry' and instead depicted a cruise or yacht, resulting in misinterpretation.
5	15	Satisfactory. Most candidates used electronic devices to convey the virtual world. Most candidates used a surrealistic style to present the theme. Some candidates left out the element of 'party' and simply painted a scene without contextualization. The interpretation of the theme was flat and uninteresting in such cases. A small number of candidates elaborated on the scene and provided the work with good and meaningful details.

Paper 2 Design

In Part A, most candidates were able to identify a variety of relevant foci in literal descriptions. They were able to provide interpretations of meaning towards forms of expression from different perspectives, with some providing

certain interpretations of meaning and recognition of embedded messages in the design of a particular context. Most candidates were able to connect different experiences and feelings with the visual forms, despite not being able to illustrate the relationships among the forms. Nevertheless, many candidates only responded to one or two criteria related to the value judgement of the artwork without judging the appropriateness of the design.

The themes of the questions were based on candidates' everyday experiences. Some performances were outstanding. However, some works lacked depth because candidates attempted the question without fulfilling all the requirements of the question. Candidates should read and follow the instructions of the question carefully. Most candidates demonstrated a mastery of materials, skills, and visual elements in delivering the key messages of a given theme. The best designs demonstrated candidates' understanding of design content and consideration of these elements, expressing a deep and thoughtful message through the design. Some good designs effectively conveyed the hidden meaning of the given theme and demonstrated a thorough understanding of the design.

Question No.	Popularity (%)	Performance in General
1	15	Good. Some candidates demonstrated maturity in concept and artful execution in dealing with the design. The best scripts showed comprehensive idea development and good illustration skills. However, a few candidates did not focus on the meaning of 'early spring' and designed their outfits without relating to the theme. A few candidates' work showed a lack of understanding of the features of a bridal gown and bridesmaid dress, and thus failed to deliver the design of the outfit.
2	36	Good. Most candidates used different images to echo the theme of 'Wonder Grandpa'. A number of candidates demonstrated good illustration skills in presenting the design effectively. However, a small number of candidates' work showed a lack of understanding of the characteristics of Wonder Grandpa: 'Tech Elite' and 'Sports Elite', resulting in a failure to deliver the design.
3	27	Satisfactory. Most candidates showed their understanding of the packaging product in their design. Designs that demonstrated good illustration skills showed a comprehensive consideration and reflection in the development of the idea. However, some candidates focused on the graphic design without considering the conformation and the structure of the packaging.
4	6	Satisfactory. Some candidates used different images of seabed creatures to echo the idea of 'under the sea'. Designs with good illustration skills were supported by comprehensive consideration and reflection in the idea development. However, a small number of candidates' work showed a lack of understanding of the features of an ancient city, resulting in a failure to deliver the design of the stage scene.
5	16	Good. Some candidates demonstrated maturity in concept and artful execution of their designs. Some candidates showed little deliberation regarding the readability and legibility of the typography design. They also showed little concern for the kerning and tracking of the letters. Some designs were overburdened with images, resulting in a superficial illustration. Some candidates limited themselves to designing delicate graphics for the online advertisement without considering the location of the advertisement or the design description in the question.

School-based Assessment

This year, a total of 384 schools and 3843 students participated in the SBA process. Among these, 5 were network schools. The schools participating in the examination were further divided into 17 groups, each of which was monitored and supported by an experienced subject teacher, as the District Coordinator who supported, coordinated, and supervised the conduct of SBA processes within the group, throughout the year.

This year, as in previous years, each school submitted marks given internally. At the same time, they provided the HKEAA with portfolios randomly drawn from six strata of the class of students. Portfolio assessors and SBA supervisors then reviewed students' sample work submitted by the schools. Visits were arranged to the schools

concerned to review the students' full portfolios in cases where there were significant differences between the scores given by schools and subject experts. Recommended mark adjustments were made after the review, if deemed necessary. The moderation process of the SBA was smooth this year, as in previous years. According to the moderated scores, 78% of schools fell within the expected range. It is extremely close to last year and hence can help illustrate that most teachers have mastered or familiarised themselves with the criteria and methods for grading the SBA component of the Visual Arts.

Two SBA supervisors were appointed this year to oversee the implementation of the SBA assessment process. Experienced Visual Arts teachers were invited to act as District Coordinators to liaise with and support the frontline Visual Arts school teachers in the SBA assessment processes. The aims are to provide quality assurance, in the form of assistance like orientation, consultation, support, and guidance, to teachers within the district to ensure that the SBA procedures are implemented in accordance with the designated criteria and requirements listed in the published HKEAA SBA Handbook.

Two district coordination meetings were organised this year. In addition, two meetings for SBA Supervisors and District Coordinators and two SBA Conferences were also conducted. Through discussing, examining and assessing actual sample portfolios, subject teachers had the chance to share experiences and/or opinions about SBA assessment. These exercises helped to foster understanding and hence maintain the standards and quality of the SBA marking.

The general performance of students in the SBA this year was satisfactory. Most of the students' Research Workbooks displayed substantial content. Their arts criticism and theme development demonstrated thorough research and exploration. The final artworks and ideas were integrated naturally and consistently. Research Workbooks for higher ability students illustrated a wide range of efforts. However, some Research Workbooks seen were too reliant on texts and had too little visual expression through the application of visual language in the art making. Students are advised to document their learning process in the form of visual images. In some portfolios, the concepts of the themes lack in-depth development. In such cases, the themes were too vague and abstract and detached from the life experience of students, thus failing to demonstrate a mastery of the relationship of content, media and style. Some Research Workbooks placed too much emphasis on the record of the information gathering process, especially on the technical sides of artworks, and neglected the execution of the artwork. The reflections in such Research Workbooks were straightforward and shallow. Most of them focused on superficial aspects with little analysis or insight.

Many Research Workbooks collected a lot of copies or second-hand information downloaded from the internet. Some even copied other people's works from the internet without giving any reason or mentioning the sources. Students should complete an assessment task honestly and responsibly in accordance with the stipulated requirements. They will be subject to severe penalties for proven malpractice, such as plagiarising others' work. This year, the artworks of a candidate were confirmed to be plagiarised work, and eventually a penalty of downgrading by one level was imposed in the subject. It should be reiterated that the HKDSE Examination Regulations stipulate that a candidate may be liable to disqualification from part or the whole of the examination or suffer a mark penalty for breaching the regulations. School teachers and students can refer to the information leaflet HKDSE Examination-Information on School-based Assessment

https://www.hkeaa.edu.hk/DocLibrary/Media/Leaflets/SBA_booklet_eng.pdf for guidance on how to properly acknowledge sources of information quoted in their works.

Despite the overall satisfactory results, some sampled works did not clearly show the four artworks and related information. The presentation of these works was messy, making viewing difficult. The use of the visual arts medium, the mastery of creative techniques, and the expression of the visual elements for artworks in these cases were judged to be inadequate, and some students were not sufficiently trained in the fundamentals, particularly in drawing and painting skills. The information for appreciation in some portfolios appeared overly simple, and the quality of the artworks was unsatisfactory. Nevertheless, the marking was found to be over-lenient.

It is recommended that school teachers and students refer to the relevant information in the Visual Arts Curriculum and Assessment Guide (Secondary 4-6) for recommendations of such operations at; https://www.edb.gov.hk/attachment/en/curriculum-development/kla/arts-edu/curriculum-docs/VA_CAGuide_e_2015.pdf

and HKDSE Visual Arts School-based Assessment Teachers' Handbook at; http://www.hkeaa.edu.hk/en/sba/sba_hkdse_elective/dse_subject.html?25&2